THIRSK DISTRICT.

THIRSK HIGH SCHOOL.
ESTABLISHED 1873.
Head Master:
The Rev. EUSEBIUS RICHARDSON, M.A. (Cambridge and Victoria Universities).
During the past year pupils have been successful in the Examinations of the Royal Dental Society; the Civil Service (open competition), the Pharmaceutical Society, and the College of Preceptors. 253

WOODLAND HOUSE, THIRSK.
BOARDING AND DAY SCHOOL FOR GIRLS.
Principals: Miss JOPLING, Miss I. JOPLING, L.R.A.M., Assisted by Resident and Visiting Teachers.
Preparation for Local Examinations.
Private Lessons given in Drawing, Oil and Water Colour Painting and Marquetorie.

THIRSK MODERN SCHOOL.
Principal: T. S. WHEATER, B.A. (Corpus Christi College, Cambridge).
For Boys between the ages of 8 and 15. Pupils prepared for Cambridge, Local, College of Preceptors, and Junior Branches of Civil Service. The School House stands in its own grounds, with cricket and football field adjoining. Reference permitted to the Lord Bishop of Chester.

THIRSK JOTTINGS.

(FROM OUR CORRESPONDENT.)

The holiday question in Thirsk is at present exciting a great amount of attention from both masters and assistants. Until a few weeks ago all the tradesmen were customarily closed on Thursday at one o'clock on Wednesdays, and thus acted in accordance with an arrangement that was come to when the subject of holiday keeping was fully discussed. A branch, however, has sprung up, and in this, as in many other matters, it is easier made than healed. The majority of the tradesmen are strongly in favour of adhering to the custom which has been so long observed in the town, and are endeavouring to make the public acquainted with that fact by issuing printed notices requesting them not to shop on Wednesday afternoons. It seems a pity that anything should happen to upset the way threatening to disturb what has hitherto been an amicable arrangement, and one that could not at first be carried out without a certain amount of trouble and labour. Some contend that if the public now suffer no inconvenience from the holiday, it being well known to exist and to have been enjoyed by both employers and employed, it is obvious that those most nearly interested should strive to maintain it.

In most towns the weekly half-day closing of shops has received general recognition, and to those thus engaged good has resulted by being freed for an interval from business cares, and an opportunity afforded for recreation of various forms. And when there is anything like unanimity amongst tradesmen the keeping of it will not involve ultimate loss, for it cannot mean any diminished production, and consequently no surplus to flood the holiday movement, and consequently we fail to see how the shopkeeper who keeps open can hope to gain much by doing so. In Thirsk it would appear that one or two only are responsible for the continued disaffection that exists. This was made clear at a recent meeting, for it transpired that some who keep open their shops do so unwillingly, but, as they stated, they feared that if they should gladly put up their shutters if fellow townsmen in the same line of business would do likewise, but they feel disinclined to act independently in the matter. As the case rests, a good deal of their desire to observe the holiday if only C will, but as the latter declines to do so because D won't, neither can they see their way to close, being in the same trade. The majority, however, are disposed to make a determined stand in seeking to maintain the holiday which they in common with other towns possess, and has now become almost universal. They appreciate the advantage which it has brought, and, as the chairman (Mr G. Dowson) remarked, that ere long legislation may probably deal with the question of hours of work, and enforce the general observance of a weekly holiday. To further their object in Thirsk an Early Closing Association has been formed, in which interest is being taken.

Apart from the above subject, it is probable that with the new year a Tradesmen's Association will be established. The matter came up at a meeting recently held, when it was discussed, and the benefits likely to accrue to the town and trade by its formation were pointed out. It was thought, however, that as Martinmas and Christmas were fast approaching, when many of them would be busy, further consideration of the proposal should remain in abeyance until the new year, and then call a meeting specially for the purpose and invite all tradesmen to be present.

The concert given on Thursday evening, in the Assembly Rooms, was gratifying in every sense. The hall was crowded, and the audience showed, by frequent rounds of applause, their high appreciation of the excellent rendering of the various items comprised in a somewhat lengthy and attractive programme. The concert was promoted and arrangements carried out by the Rev C. S. de Courcy Ireland, to whom praise is due for the great amount of interest and trouble he took to make the event what it really was—a splendid success. It not only afforded a treat to lovers of good music, but would be the means of helping the building fund of Sowerby National School, towards which the proceeds were devoted.

The Thirsk Cricket Club have arranged to hold their annual ball, and it is hoped that no other event will clash with the fixture. On the last occasion it was somewhat unfortunate that another popular gathering was held in the town the same night. The attendance at each was no doubt affected by the occurrence.

THE OPIUM TRAFFIC.

A public meeting was held in the Assembly Rooms, Thirsk, under the auspices of the Yorkshire Branch of the Society for the Suppression of the Opium Traffic. There was a large and attentive audience. The chair was occupied by the Rev W. Teasdale Mackintosh (Vicar of Thirsk), and he was supported by Sir Matthew Dodsworth, Bart. (Kilvey) Rom, of the Rev Hudson Taylor (the Rev J. S. Adams (Missionary in China), the Rev Geo. Gill, the Rev J. Laverick, the Rev Mr Whitehead, Mr J. W. Hall, &c. After prayer had been offered by the Rev Mr Whitehead.

The CHAIRMAN announced the object of the meeting as one in which Christian people of all denominations could unite and work together hand in hand. He were sorry to see the Chinese so far behind up to the highest civilization a vast multitude of their fellow-creatures who were sunk in deep degradation, and misery, through the ill-effects of the opium trade. He hoped this would be a great golden rule of life, "to do unto others as we would have them do unto us." By means of this good principle the dreadful curse of slavery was now almost abolished, and he felt sure that the same good rule of life were extended to the opium traffic, all the sorrow and suffering connected with it would soon be swept away.

The Rev J. S. ADAMS, who had spent 17 years as a missionary in Burmah and China, then addressed the meeting, and spoke of the sad sights he had seen during the course of his labours abroad, owing to the great abuse of this dangerous drug—an abuse which in India and Burmah at least—our Imperial Government was morally responsible for, seeing that it controlled the manufacture and sale of opium for the purpose of sensual indulgence, which led to the destruction of thousands of our fellow-creatures every year.

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The Rev J. LAVERICK seconded the motion, whereupon the Chairman put it to the meeting, and it was carried unanimously.

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The motion was seconded by Mr J. W. HALL, and carried nem. con.

A vote of thanks having been accorded to the Chairman, the proceedings were brought to a close.

THIRSK PETTY SESSIONS.

MONDAY.—Before the Hon. G. E. Lascelles (chairman), Captain Turton, Mr R. Aikenhead, and Captain Sell.

A "TOUGHEY" IN TROUBLE.—Alexander Senter was charged with vagrancy, in Sowerby. Sergeant Shields said he saw prisoner begging in Belgrave-terrace, from door to door. Committed for a month to gaol.

ALLEGED ARSON.—George Ellis appeared on remand charged with setting fire to a barley straw stack, the property of Mr John H. Greenhill, Thirsk Lodge, in a field adjoining Newsham-road. The owner was left safe on the night of the 13th inst., and on the following morning William Brown took him certain information, upon which he went to the field, and the stack was burning all round. The stack was worth £20. Ellis had been in his employment since harvest as a flag man for an engine. During the week before the fire prisoner had not attended regularly to his work, and Mr Greenhill was obliged to get another man. On Saturday evening prisoner left the place about 6 o'clock at night the day after the fire, the prisoner expressed his desire to see him at the police station, and then said that if he would forgive him he would pay for the straw. He also said something about "begging pardon." Mr Greenhill asked him if he had any grudge against him, and he said he had not, and that the conflagration was an accident when he was lighting his pipe. He became frightened, and ran away. There are three or four stacks in the next field belonging to Mr Pick. The prisoner helped to thrash the stack, but he had no right in the field afterwards. Wm. Brown, farm labourer, Thirsk, and working for Mr Skelton at the Manor Farm, and who first saw the fire, observed the prisoner in the vicinity of the stack. The prisoner was frightened by running, and said the fire might have been caused by some "campers." Mr Thomas Greenhill, of Newsham, said: I know the prisoner; he has not been regular with his work.—Cross-examined by Mr Wilkinson, Saturday, the 12th inst., he arrested the prisoner, who said "I did not set fire to that stack this morning. I was round the stack at 6 o'clock on the Sandhutton road, and passed the Railway Station, through Sandhutton to Mr Greenhill's, at Newsham, and I came back the same way." When charged with the offence Ellis said, "I have told you a lot of lies, and I will tell the truth. I did not do it wilfully. I struck a match to light my pipe and threw it down, and when I saw the stack burning I felt frightened and ran away."—Inspector Wm. Cook having cautioned the Chairman, addressing the prisoner, said: "This is a very serious offence, and we are obliged to send you for trial by a jury; therefore you stand committed for trial at the Assizes."

THE BISHOP OF BATHURST AND HIS WORK.

There was a crowded congregation at the Parish Church, on Sunday evening, when the preacher was the Ven. T. D. Colin Campbell, Archdeacon of Bathurst, New South Wales. In the course of his sermon, based on the text, "Not far from everyone of us," he spoke of many things that were near to men, one of which—death—they in Thirsk especially had lately received warning. The primary significance of the words, however, was the nearness of God, and on this fact the preacher dwelt. At the close the Archdeacon said he was there as a passing stranger, but he had come to their town and church with great interest. It was a church he had heard of for some years, and a building which he knew from the graphic representations which adorned the episcopal house of his Bishop, who was formerly vicar of this parish. One of his objects in coming to this land, after years of labour in his own, was to seek help. He came from a land that was, as they knew, vast in extent, and which was a dioceses in itself, the size of Scotland, and he thought they would be interested in the land where their former Vicar now labours very actively in his episcopal charge. His difficulties, he pointed out, were of a kindly character, their bishop desired to increase the number of his clergy, and, if possible, to increase their incomes; and he thought they might be inclined to send some help to the Bishop of Bathurst (and from Thirsk, which would encourage him, and give him to realise that some of his old friends still remembered him and wished to give him a helping hand. The land in which Bishop Camidge laboured, and in which the preacher had laboured for for twenty years, was not only interesting, but one which had a claim upon English people. It was a land of fertile meads, of gold and silver; a land where there was plenty of elbow room for people who were sober and industrious; it only wanted one thing—the proper kind of population. It would be a great pity if it got into a bad empire in the South, allied to England, but still a mighty dominion. In this country they had their beautiful services and means of grace; God seemed to flood the people of England with opportunities, and in a new land they had had everything to begin, therefore their difficulties were great. England poured forth her population to every quarter of the globe, and sent a portion to Bathurst. They came to different parts, and they had to go after them, minister to them, and do what they could to prevent them lapsing into white heathenism. He would close by asking their liberality and their prayers if they would think of Bishop Camidge and those who were working under him. He would commend the matter to them, asking for their sympathy and also asking them that night and every night for their prayerful intercession at the throne of grace that the blessing of Him who was not far from everyone of them might abundantly rest upon them.

MARTINMAS HIRINGS.—On Monday, the second of the statutes for the Martinmas term took place in the Market-square, but there was nothing like the number of servants, either male or female, there was on the same day on Monday. The Assembly Rooms were again thrown open for the accommodation of the females. Wages, more especially among farm men, had again a downward tendency, and little or no contracts were made, many men returning home unhired.

A TOUR THROUGH NORWAY.

This formed the subject of a most interesting lecture delivered in the Assembly Rooms, Thirsk, on Thursday evening, by Dr E. H. Jacob, professor of pathology, Yorkshire College, Leeds. Dr Hartley presided, and there was a large and attentive audience. The chair was occupied by the Rev W. Teasdale Mackintosh (Vicar of Thirsk), and he was supported by Sir Matthew Dodsworth, Bart. (Kilvey) Rom, of the Rev Hudson Taylor (the Rev J. S. Adams (Missionary in China), the Rev Geo. Gill, the Rev J. Laverick, the Rev Mr Whitehead, Mr J. W. Hall, &c. After prayer had been offered by the Rev Mr Whitehead.

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The motion was seconded by Mr J. W. HALL, and carried nem. con.

GRAND CONCERT AT THIRSK.

On Thursday evening a most successful concert was given in the Assembly Rooms, Thirsk, before a large and fashionable audience, the proceeds being in aid of the building fund of Sowerby National School. It had been promoted by the Rev E. S. de Courcy Ireland, who had spared no pains to secure a series of accomplished artistes, and it to place before the audience an attractive programme, which was well sustained throughout. The first part opened with a well-played pianoforte duet, selections from "Mikado," by Mr and Miss Kitchingman. "Sunshine and Rain," and "Espanita" were the titles of songs sung very effectively by Mrs Holgate, of Harrogate, who were greatly appreciated. Mr Duncanson, Durham, merited and received an encore after singing "In Cellar Cool," and in response to the recall sang "Rocked in the Cradle of the Deep," which was rendered so beautiful that the encore Miss Minnie Green, Pateley Bridge, was warmly applauded for the rendering of the song "When the heart is young," and Mr Wilkinson, Durham, followed with a pianoforte solo, which also responded "The Fog bell," Balfe's popular duet, "Excelsior," was rendered in fine style by Messrs Duncanson and Clement, whose re-appearance was loudly encored, for, and Miss Green, Leeds, sang with telling effect "When in the early morn." For his singing of the song "The star of Bethlehem." Mr Hunter, Hartlepool, was recalled, and he showed his appreciation of the encore. The first part of the programme was concluded by Miss Edith Cass, rendering with much sweetness a song entitled "The Reason Why." The Rev E. Richardson commended the concert by singing a humorous song, "The Flying Dutchman," which met with approbation. Miss Minnie Green followed with the song, "Esmeralda," which was sung in a manner that showed her appreciation of the encore she responded by singing "The Snyder Zee." Mr A. Busfield was in good voice, and his rendering of the song entitled "The Carrier Dove" also elicited an encore. Miss Beecroft, Darlington, responded for her song, "O that we two were married." The encore was certainly well deserved, and in response she sang "When love is kind." "The ship was saved by Magic" was the title of a song sung by Mr Wilkinson, who, in answer to a recall, caused some hilarity by his rendering of a humorous song entitled "Waiting." Mr A. G. Clement sang "Leonora," which was heartily encored. "Belsy and I" was the song given by Mr Duncanson, whose effort was not less successful than on his former appearance, an encore being again conceded. Often he responded to the encore of Mr Hunter met with approbation for his song, "Island of Dreams," and a recitation, "Execution of Mountrose," which he gave at a subsequent stage of the programme, was well received. Miss Green, the last item was the song, "Loving Evermore," which Miss Beecroft sang with capital effect. The accompaniments were admirably played by Mr Herbert E. R. Walton, A.R.C.M., organist of St. Mark's Church, Leeds, who also greatly pleased the audience by his accomplished rendering of a piano solo, "Etude in Fileuse." The concert, which was most enjoyable throughout, was brought to a close by the singing of the National Anthem. A collection of very beautiful flowering plants emblematic.

THE RAILWAY DISASTER NEAR THIRSK.

At the fortnightly meeting of the members of the York branch of the Associated Society of Locomotive Engineers and Firemen, held on Sunday, the following resolution was unanimously passed and forwarded to the Secretary of the Board of the ill-fated Scotch express, who lies at the Cottage Hospital at Thirsk:—"That we desire to convey to you our sincere sympathy. Also our high appreciation of your courage and presence of mind in connection with the deplorable accident in which the nature of your calling placed you at Manor House, and to say we consider that the very fact of your being in your engine-room at the time proved of your being in your engine-room at the time proved help a fund for the poorer clergy in his diocese. They laboured under great disadvantages and difficulties. Bishop Camidge was a most kindly charge, their bishop desired to increase the number of his clergy, and, if possible, to increase their incomes; and he thought they might be inclined to send some help to the Bishop of Bathurst (and from Thirsk, which would encourage him, and give him to realise that some of his old friends still remembered him and wished to give him a helping hand. The land in which Bishop Camidge laboured, and in which the preacher had laboured for for twenty years, was not only interesting, but one which had a claim upon English people. It was a land of fertile meads, of gold and silver; a land where there was plenty of elbow room for people who were sober and industrious; it only wanted one thing—the proper kind of population. It would be a great pity if it got into a bad empire in the South, allied to England, but still a mighty dominion. In this country they had their beautiful services and means of grace; God seemed to flood the people of England with opportunities, and in a new land they had had everything to begin, therefore their difficulties were great. England poured forth her population to every quarter of the globe, and sent a portion to Bathurst. They came to different parts, and they had to go after them, minister to them, and do what they could to prevent them lapsing into white heathenism. He would close by asking their liberality and their prayers if they would think of Bishop Camidge and those who were working under him. He would commend the matter to them, asking for their sympathy and also asking them that night and every night for their prayerful intercession at the throne of grace that the blessing of Him who was not far from everyone of them might abundantly rest upon them.

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The motion was seconded by Mr J. W. HALL, and carried nem. con.

FIELD AND STOCK-YARD.

OUR WEEKLY AGRICULTURAL REVIEW.

Apparently the fat-stock shows of the present season are to be well up to the mark. We have already referred to the numerous entries for the Smithfield Show, and at the Norwich Show, which closed on Saturday week, the number was equal to that of any but one previously recorded, while the entries for the Birmingham Show, to be opened to-day, are above average. The almost complete immunity from the two principal diseases of cattle and sheep which the country has recently enjoyed is probably accountable for a measure of success at these exhibitions, which is remarkable in the face of severe depression.

The numerous meetings held in the provinces to appoint delegates to the National Agricultural Conference, and to instruct them as to the views of those whom they will represent, afford conclusive evidence of the popularity of the propositions demonstrated. Unfortunately, as usual in relation to agriculture, an almost hopeless division of opinion as to the best remedies for the existing distress has been manifested at the meetings, and it is to be feared that we shall have a perfect Babel of suggestions for discussion at the Conference, including such questions as the readjustment of local taxation, the suppression at home and exclusion from abroad of all the contagious diseases of live stock, and the effectual prevention of fraud in the disposal of adulterated products, such as are sold or bought by farmers, there is almost complete unanimity among all classes of agriculturists. Upon almost all other important points, however, there is a strong division of opinion. Tenants are generally agreed as to the necessity of a further reduction of rents, but landlords and their agents naturally take a somewhat different view of the question, and they are supported by a great majority of the farmers in resisting all attempts to introduce the principle of compulsory arbitration. Best three of the Associations to be represented at the Conference have distinctly demanded the three F's, to which the bulk of English tenants are as adverse as ever they were. A much more common demand will be for protection, to which many of the delegates are inclined. There is no doubt of the popularity among farmers of this expedient as a remedy for depression, including a great number of men who have been Free Traders until recently. Still, many of them recognise the hopelessness of the demand, for the present, at any rate; and, therefore, much as they would like to see the fiscal policy of the country altered, they are unable to regard an agitation with that end in view as a means of immediate relief. Again, while Bimetallism has probably gained ground among agriculturists than among any other class, it is regarded as a mere fad by a great number of them. The danger is that barely all the time of the Conference will be taken up with the discussion of these exciting topics, to the neglect of plans of self-help by means of combination and co-operation.

The crisis has brought into notice once more old plans which have been tried to some extent in the past, without giving satisfaction—sliding-scale rents and wages. The former are not uncommon in some of the arable districts many years ago, but fell into disuse, as farmers preferred to take their chance in market fluctuations. Moreover, as the prices of stock were usually low if those of corn were high, and vice versa, many farmers found the system very hardly more in accordance with total returns than fixed rents were. It is now proposed to arrange what are styled produce rents, taking the price of other farm produce besides corn into consideration, but standards for a sliding scale would have to vary to a perplexing extent in order to represent in approximately accurate proportion the several products of different farms. There was a time, too, when farmers usually raised or lowered wages as the market rose or fell in produce, but now the labourers had no voice in the matter. Speaking at the meeting of the Isle of Thanet Agricultural Association last week, Mr James Lowther advocated sliding-scale wages, because, as long as agricultural labourers were able to say that they were better off when wheat was at its lowest price than when it was at its highest, it would be impossible to persuade them that if an industry could not be carried on with profit, it should not be carried on by their aid connected with it. There is nothing unfair in the proposal; but, with the present outlook as to the price of wheat, the labourers would certainly not willingly accept it. They might be forced to tolerate the plan during the winter, but the result would almost certainly be increased migration to the towns in the spring and summer. It is also to be observed that the "higgling of the market" with respect to farms and labour is practically equivalent to sliding-scale rents and wages; for rents rise and fall as farming becomes more or less profitable, and wages do the same, when other conditions are stable. It is true that farm wages have not generally fallen during the long period of depression; but they have been kept from the advance which would certainly have taken place if farming had been prosperous, seeing that the supply of agricultural labour has been greatly reduced in nearly all parts of the country.

Mr C. Clay, a well-known Yorkshire agriculturist, and the author of "Profit and Loss in Agriculture," has communicated to a correspondent of the *Leeds Mercury* the results of a comparison which he has worked out between the returns of farms in the United Kingdom in 1871 and in 1891. Including corn, meat, wool, hops, and butter and milk, but not dairy produce or hops (for which he could not obtain satisfactory figures), and taking the official figures of acreage, yield, and market prices, Mr Clay makes the total annual return for 1891 less than it would have been in 1871 by £19,000,000 of money, or £1 12s. 4½d. on every acre of land in the total cultivated area (crops, grass, and bare fallow) of the Kingdom. The total annual loss thus declared is nearly 19 millions sterling in excess of the gross rent of agricultural land, as assessed for income tax under Schedule A. Mr Clay gives his items; but it is difficult to examine his figures advantageously without going through the whole of the calculations independently. The loss due to the drop in the price of corn is put at over 22 millions sterling, and this is based upon official averages. But when a loss of £7,730,578, or £6 an acre, is shown on potatoes, there is room for doubt, seeing that the average cost of all the potatoes imported in 1891 was fully 2s. per cwt. higher in 1891 than in 1871. Again, it is not easy to imagine why Mr Clay has allowed a loss of 10s. an acre on all roots, vetches, and some other feeding crops, in addition to £20,692,000 on the meat produced from the consumption of these crops; or why a loss of over 17 millions sterling is put down for hay, mainly consumed on farms. There is even some doubt whether 1½d. a pound is not too great a reduction to allow on all the meat sold, including mutton, which in 1890 at any rate was slightly higher than in 1871. The yearly averages for meat published by the Board of Agriculture have not yet appeared for 1891, but will be in the complete agricultural returns for 1892. However, Mr Clay might have allowed for a loss on dairy produce, and especially on milk. In addition to the fall in annual returns, he proceeds to make out a drop of £64,000,000 in the value of live stock on farms, including £5,000,000 on horses, which, however, have risen in value since 1871.

AT the Taunton Assizes, on Tuesday, Joseph Phillips, of Bath, was sentenced to five years' penal servitude by Mr Justice Collins for the manslaughter of his wife.

MR HENRY CHAPLIN, M.P., who recently offered to the Lindsey County Council a large farm in North Lincolnshire for the purpose of providing small holdings, has just offered to the Kesteven County Council, South Lincolnshire, a farm of nearly 700 acres at Temple Bruer, near Sleaford, for similar purposes.

THAT CLOCK IN OXFORD STREET.

You may see it from the top of a 'bus any day. It is on the outside wall of a building a short way west of the Circus. Sometimes this clock is right, sometimes wrong; and erstwhile it takes a rest and never moves a hand. Then it feels refreshed and goes ahead again. On the dial is this inscription: "*Delay not; time flies.*" Let us hope that the 'bus drivers and messenger boys will lay the impressive fact to heart. For time flew before clocks were invented, and it flies just the same when wheels break and weights go to sleep at the bottom of the clock cases. Whether we dream or wake, laugh or cry, make money or lose it, Time keeps his own flapping. The more comfort and also the night, no matter whether weddings or funerals are sandwiched between them.

Now suppose we apply the principle, and first name a date—the year 1889. In November of that year a certain gentleman, in pursuit of his vocation, caught what he calls (like the rest of us) a "chill." This "chill" was not the result necessarily of exposure to cold, for people "catch colds" and have "chills" in the hottest weather. This is queer, considering the nance he gave to these sensations. In very truth we are overtaken with them oftener in summer than in winter. Why so? Because in the proper sense they are not chills at all, but a nervous disorder arising from low vitality and some kind of poisoning in the blood. Most fevers begin with a chill, although the thermometer may show 100deg. of heat. So much for that. It is worth storing away in your memory.

After the chill the gardener found that something ailed his ankle; he could walk only with difficulty. A fortnight later he could not walk at all. When he moved his foot the pain made him feel faint. This was bad, especially for a man whose work possibly required him to use his feet. The pain was so severe that it induced him to bed and wrapped up his legs in cotton wool. Then, it goes without saying, he began swallowing doses of medicine. A week more and he was covered all over with large boils. He was now in condition to understand one at least of the afflictions of Job.

As to the boils they were the result of nature's effort to expel the poison from this man's blood. Nature does nothing from mere whim, neither does she love to torment any of her children. Nature's people don't persecute them, and so they try to dry the boils up, or drive them in, while she tries to make them little volcanoes to carry off the inside fire. Oblige the writer by remembering this also.

From this point on we will let the gardener tell his own tale. He says of himself in said plight. I had my club doctor attending me for three weeks, but got worse, and feared I was going to be laid up for a long time. The pain seemed fixed in my knees, and I suffered intensely. I had another month of this and then got relief in a way I will tell you of. While I was on my back and my work waiting for me, a took—a small paper-covered one—was left at my house. It told of Mother Seigel's Syrup, and how a case like mine was cured by the medicine. I sent at once to Sir Smith's stores, at Penge, and got a bottle, and found relief almost directly; for *I got the medicine on the Monday, and by the following Friday I was able to walk two miles!* On the next Monday I went to my work. I had been never had any return of the ailment since. I think the chill put my blood out of order.—A. GEORGE, 15, Southey Street, Penge, near London."

In his last conjecture Mr. George is mistaken. It was not the chill, but the blood was out of order, but it was his blood being out of order that gave him the chill, and also the boils and the attack of acute rheumatism that trailed after. How long do you suppose it is going to take us to get the proper idea of Truth that rheumatism is an inflammation of the joints and muscles caused by uric acid in the blood, and that this acid arises from fermented food in the stomach—indigestion and dyspepsia? We can't say; but we shall keep on lecturing them till we do know. Meanwhile, as they groan and howl from gout, rheumatism, and other sorts of explosions of inner stomach poisons, they will shorten their sufferings by taking Seigel's Syrup to drive out the poison. Say it in a more comprehensive way—Be absolut all the pangs and ills I ever suffered from, or ever will, are symptoms of indigestion and dyspepsia," and you'll finally possess the biggest nugget of wisdom you ever had in your life.

As to that clock in Oxford Street. If Mr. George had taken Seigel's Syrup when he was ill, he would, on getting out again, have found himself six weeks late. For *time flies*, even when a man can't employ an hour of it to advantage.

BILLS OF SALE AND FAILURES.

(From *Stubbs' Weekly Gazette.*)

In the week ending November 19th there were 181 bills of sale registered in England and Wales, a decrease of 32 as compared with the corresponding period last year. The receiving orders gazetted were 122, showing an increase of 36, and the number of registered deeds of arrangement was 77, an increase of 11. In Ireland there were 58 judgments registered, an increase of 7; bills of sale 6, showing a decrease of 3; bankruptcies gazetted 10, a decrease of 0; and the registered deeds of arrangement 6, a decrease of 4. The Scotch returns show that we have published 10 recorded petitions, a decrease of 3; and 20 failures, being a decrease of 6.

The totals for the portion of the year to November 19th are bills of sale registered for England and Wales, 7,480, an increase of 1,027; receiving orders gazetted number 4,056, an increase of 363, and the registered deeds of arrangement 3,144 an increase of 822. In Ireland the totals are judgments 2,360, an increase of 90; bills of sale 270, a decrease of 29; and the bankruptcies gazetted number 184, an increase of 36; and the registered deeds of arrangement 268, a decrease of 11. In Scotland the totals are recorded petitions 407, an increase of 114; and the failures 1,156, a decrease of 3.

According to *Stubbs' Weekly Gazette*, the number of failures published during the week ending November 19th was 200. The number in the corresponding week of last year was 153, showing an increase of 47. The last figures were distributed as follows, with the corresponding comparison we give the number in each in the corresponding weeks of 1891 and 1890.

	1892.	1891	1890.
Builders, Building Materials	22	21	14
Chemists and Druggists ...	2	—	1
China, Glass, Earthenware ...	3	—	3
Confectionery, Toys, Fancy Goods ...	5	5	6
Corn, Coals, Minerals ...	11	2	2
Drapery, Clothing Textiles	39	24	23
Farmers	11	4	7
Furniture, Upholstery ...	3	3	3
Horses, Vehicles	2	3	2
Jewellery, Watches ...	—	2	1
Leather	16	11	15
Metals	3	7	4
Paper, Printing, &c. ...	3	7	4
Provisions	41	23	27
Wines, Spirits, Beer, Tobacco	15	13	8
Miscellaneous...	21	24	35
	200	153	145

The number of bills of sale in England and Wales, registered at the Queen's Bench for the week ending November 19th was 181. The number in the corresponding week of last year was 213, and the total number of bills of the three previous years 150, 185, and 205.

TWO CHILDREN DROWNED.—Christiana and Elizabeth Drennan, aged ten and two respectively, were discovered drowned in the canal at Redcliffe, Lancashire, on Monday. How they got there is uncertain.

THE DOUGLAS TRAGEDY.—The trial of George J. B. Cooper, on the charge of murdering his wife at an hotel in Douglas, Isle of Man, was concluded on Monday. Deemster Drinkwater, in summing up, reviewed the circumstances of the case, and, in connection with them, pointed out the legal difference between murder and manslaughter. The jury found the prisoner guilty of manslaughter, and he was sentenced to ten years' penal servitude.

STATIONS OF THE BRITISH ARMY.

NOVEMBER.

(COMPILED FROM THE "BRITISH ARMY LIST.")

Where two places are mentioned, the last named is that in which the Depôt of the Regiment is stationed.

CAVALRY.

1st Life Gds., Sherncliffe
2nd ditto, St. John's Wood.
Royal Horse Guards (Blue), Hyde Park
1st Drag. Gds., Windsor
2nd, Scotch Brigade, Bngl.
3rd, Natal
4th, Aldershot
5th, Aldershot
6th, Edinburgh
7th, Manchr.
1st Dragoons, York
2nd Dragoons, Dublin
3rd Hussars, Dublin
5th Cavalrs
6th Lancs, Meerut, Bengal
6th Dragoons, Brighton
7th Hussars, Ahmednagar
8th Hussars, Aldershot
9th Lancers, Preston
10th Hussars, Ballincollig
11th Hussars, Aldershot
12th, Dundalk
16th Lancers, Lucknow, Bengal
17th, Aldershot
18th Hussars, Umballa, Bombay
19th, Bangalore
20th, Aldershot
21st, Secunderabad, Madras

INFANTRY.

Grenadier Guards, 1st bat, Windsor; 2nd bat, Chelsea; 3rd bat, Wellington Barracks
Coldstream Guards, 1st bat, Chelsea; 2nd bat, Tower
Scots Guards, 1st bat, Dublin; 2nd bat, Wellington Barracks

TERRITORIAL REGIMENTS.

Royal Scots (1st Foot), 1st bat, Stirling, Edinburgh
R. W. Surr., R. (2nd), Malta, Guildford; 2nd bat, Dinapore, Bengal
R. Kent, R. (3rd), Fort William, Bengal, Canterbury; 2nd bat, Chatham
R. Lanc., R. (4th), Aldershot, Lancaster; 2nd bat, Ahmednagar, Bombay; Lancaster
Northum. Fus. (5th), Fenham, Newcastle-on-Tyne; 2nd bat, Norahera; Newcastle-on-Tyne
R. Warwickshire R. (6th), Aldershot, Warwick; 2nd bat, Ceylon; Warwick
R. Fus. (7th), Quetta, Hounslow; 2nd bat, Woolwich; Dublin
Liverpool R. (8th), Bermuda, Warrington; 2nd bat, Aldershot; Warrington
Norfolk R. (9th), Burmah, Norwich; 2nd bat, Colchester, Norwich
Linc. R. (10th), Aldershot, Lincoln; 2nd bat, Singapore, Lincoln
Devon. R. (11th), Egypt, Exeter; 2nd bat, Burmah, Exeter
Suff. R. (12th), Colchester, Bury St. Edmunds; 2nd bat, Secunderabad, Madras; Bury St. Edmunds
Som. R. (13th), Gibraltar, Taunton; 2nd bat, Madras
W. York. R. (14th), Preston, York; 2nd bat, Bengal, York
E. York. R. (15th), Cowglown, Beverley; 2nd bat, Manchester, Beverley